



STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP)

Process Title:	Student File Clearance and Records Management		
Department:	Student Admissions Department		
SOP ID:	LIS/ACO-SAD/SOP/001		
Effective Date:	2025/12/08	Revision Number:	V00

1. PURPOSE

This Standard Operating Procedure establishes a systematic process for managing, maintaining, and disposing of student files at Leeds International School to ensure compliance with record retention requirements while safeguarding original documents and maintaining institutional records efficiently.

2. SCOPE

This SOP applies to all student files across all branches of Leeds International School and is to be implemented by Admission Officers under the supervision of Branch Principals.

3. DEFINITIONS

Master Sheet: A comprehensive Excel database containing key information for all enrolled and departed students.

Closed File: A student file where all original certificates and transcripts have been collected by the student/guardian, containing only photocopies and supporting documents.

Open File: A student file containing one or more original documents including birth certificates, result sheets, or leaving certificates.

Supporting Documents: All documentation other than original certificates, including application forms, photocopies, correspondence, and supplementary materials.

Vault: Safe storage location at the branch. This may be a lockable rooms or office area

4. RESPONSIBILITIES

Branch Admission Officer:

- Maintain and update the Master Sheet
- Monitor file retention timelines
- Conduct file audits and classification
- Coordinate document scanning and notifications
- Manage document destruction processes

Branch Principal:

- a) Approve file disposal and destruction
- b) Oversee compliance with this SOP
- c) Authorize vault transfers

5. PROCEDURE

5.1 Master Sheet Maintenance

The Admission Officer shall maintain a Master Sheet in Excel format containing the following mandatory fields for each student:

- a) Admission Number
- b) Full Name of Student
- c) Date of Admission
- d) Academic Scheme (Edexcel/National)
- e) Date of Leaving School
- f) File Status (Active/Closed/Open/Vault/Destroyed)
- g) Last Contact Date (for notification tracking)
- h) Scanning Completion Date
- i) Document Collection Status
- j) Final Disposal Date (if applicable)

The Master Sheet must be updated within 48 hours of any change in student status.

5.2 Initial File Retention Period (Years 1-5)

All student files shall be retained in the Admissions Office filing system for a minimum of **five (5) years** from the date the student leaves the school. During this period:

- a) Files must be stored in a secure, environment
- b) Files must remain easily accessible for reference or document collection
- c) No disposal or destruction of files is permitted

5.3 Five-Year Review and File Classification

Upon completion of the five-year retention period, the Branch Admission Officer shall conduct a comprehensive review of all eligible files. Each file must be classified as follows:

5.3.1 Closed File Criteria

A file may be classified as "Closed" if ALL of the following conditions are met:

- a) Leaving Certificate has been collected by student/parent/guardian
- b) All academic transcripts have been collected
- c) No original documents (i.e., Birth Certificates) remain in the file

Action: Closed files shall be removed from active storage with Principal approval and properly disposed of according to Section 5.9.

5.3.2 Open File Criteria

A file must be classified as "Open" if ANY of the following original documents are present:

- a) Original Birth Certificate
- b) Original Result Sheets (examination certificates)
- c) Original Leaving Certificate
- d) Any other original certificates or credentials

Action: Open files must proceed to the document scanning and notification process outlined in Section 5.4.

5.4 Document Scanning and Parent/ Guardian/ Student Notification

For all Open Files identified in the five-year review:

5.4.1 Scanning Process

The Admission Officer shall:

- a) Scan all original documents in the file at high resolution (minimum 300 DPI, color)
- b) Scan the following documents as priority items:
 - i. Application Form
 - ii. Original Birth Certificate
 - iii. Original Certificates and Result Sheets
 - iv. Leaving Certificate
 - v. Any special documents (disciplinary letters, appreciation letters, achievement certificates, medical records)
- c) Save scanned documents in PDF format with the naming convention as mentioned in Section 9:

[Admission Number]_[Student Name]_[Document Type]_[Date]
- d) Store digital files in the school's secure document management system with appropriate backup
- e) Update the Master Sheet with scanning completion date

5.4.2 Parent/Guardian/ Student Notification

Within seven (7) days of completing the scanning process, the Admission Officer shall:

- a) Contact the student/parent/guardian via:
 - i. Registered email
 - ii. Phone call (with documented call log)
 - iii. Registered post (if email and phone contact fail)
- b) The notification must clearly state:

- i. List of original documents available for collection
 - ii. School office hours and collection location
 - iii. Deadline for collection (minimum 30 days from notification date)
 - iv. Consequence of non-collection (transfer to vault storage/ Destruction)
 - v. Contact information for queries
- c) Document all notification attempts in the Master Sheet

5.5 Document Collection and File Processing

5.5.1 Successful Collection

When a student/parent/guardian collects original documents:

- a) Verify identity with government-issued photo identification
- b) Obtain signed acknowledgment of document receipt
- c) Retain scanned copies in the digital archive
- d) Destroy all supporting documents per Section 5.9
- e) Update Master Sheet status to "Closed - Collected"
- f) Move file to closed status

5.5.2 non-Collection

If original documents are not collected within the specified timeframe:

- a) All original documents shall be transferred to the branch vault for secure custody
- b) All supporting documents (photocopies, correspondence, application forms) shall be destroyed per Section 5.9
- c) Update Master Sheet status to "Vault Storage"
- d) Record vault transfer date and location

5.6 Ten-Year Final Review and Notification

After **ten (10) years** from the date the student left the school, the Admission Officer shall conduct a final review of all files in vault storage:

5.6.1 Final Notification Process

- a) Conduct a comprehensive attempt to contact student/parent/guardian using all available contact information
- b) Issue final notification via:
 - i. Registered email with read receipt
 - ii. Registered post to last known address
 - iii. Phone calls to all available numbers
- c) Final notification must clearly state:
 - i. This is the final opportunity to collect original documents
 - ii. Collection deadline: seven (7) calendar days from notification date

- iii. After the deadline, all original documents will be permanently destroyed
- iv. No extensions will be granted

- d) Document all notification attempts with dates, methods, and responses

5.7 Final Document Destruction

If the student/parent/guardian fails to collect documents within the seven-day final grace period:

- a) Prepare a Document Destruction List including:
 - i. Student name and admission number
 - ii. Complete inventory of documents to be destroyed
 - iii. Date of final notification
 - iv. Proof of notification attempts
- b) Obtain written approval from the Branch Principal
- c) Conduct document destruction per Section 5.9
- d) Update Master Sheet status to "Destroyed - Date [DD/MM/YYYY]"
- e) Retain destruction records for audit purposes

5.8 Digital Archive Management

5.8.1 Permanent Digital Storage

All scanned documents shall be:

- a) Stored indefinitely in the school's secure document management system
- b) Backed up on multiple secure servers/cloud storage
- c) Protected with encryption and access controls
- d) Made available for legitimate requests with proper authorization

5.8.2 Digital Archive Access

Access to digital archives requires:

- a) Written authorization from the Branch Principal
- b) Documented purpose for access
- c) Access log maintenance for audit trail

5.9 Document Destruction Protocol

All document destruction must follow these mandatory procedures:

- a) **Approval:** Obtain written approval from Branch Principal with attached destruction list
- b) **Method:**
 - i. Paper documents: Cross-cut shredding
 - ii. Digital media (if any): Secure data wiping per industry standards

c) **Documentation:**

- i. Create Certificate of Destruction listing all files/documents destroyed
- ii. Include date, method, and witnesses
- iii. Obtain signatures from Admission Officer and Principal

d) **Record Retention:**

- i. Maintain Certificates of Destruction permanently
- ii. Update Master Sheet with destruction details

6. TIMELINE SUMMARY

Event	Timeline	Action Required
Student Leaves School	Day 0	Update Master Sheet
Initial Retention	Years 1-5	Maintain files in Admissions Office
Five-Year Review	Year 5	Classify as Closed or Open
Document Scanning	Within 7 days of review	Scan all originals in Open Files
First Notification	Within 7 days of scanning	Contact guardian for collection
Collection Period	30+ days	Allow document collection
Vault Transfer	After collection period	Transfer uncollected originals to vault
Ten-Year Review	Year 10	Final contact attempt
Final Grace Period	7 days	Last opportunity for collection
Final Destruction	After grace period	Destroy uncollected originals
Digital Archive	Indefinite	Maintain scanned documents permanently

7. RECORD RETENTION

The following records shall be maintained:

- a) **Master Sheet:** Indefinitely
- b) **Scanned Documents:** Indefinitely
- c) **Certificates of Destruction:** Indefinitely
- d) **Notification Records:** Minimum 3 years
- e) **Collection Acknowledgments:** Minimum 3 years

8. COMPLIANCE AND AUDIT

- a) This SOP shall be reviewed annually and updated as necessary
- b) Compliance audits shall be conducted semi-annually by the Principal
- c) Any deviations from this SOP must be documented and approved by the Principal
- d) Staff implementing this SOP shall receive training upon onboarding and annual refresher training

9. DOCUMENT NAMING CONVENTIONS AND STANDARDS

To ensure consistency, accuracy, and compatibility across all digital systems, the following standards must be strictly adhered to when scanning and saving student documents.

9.1 Document Type Codes and Abbreviations

All documents must be categorized using the following standardized three-letter codes:

Document Type	Abbreviation Code
Application Form	APL
Birth Certificate	BCR
Academic Certificates / Result Sheets	ACT
Leaving Certificates	LCR
Disciplinary Documents	DCP
Achievements / Appreciation Documents	ACH
Other Documents	OTR

Usage: Always use the three-letter abbreviation code (in uppercase) when saving scanned documents.

9.2 Student Name Format

a. Mandatory Requirements:

- Both first name and second name must be included in all record keeping
- Use an underscore (_) as the separator between first name and second name
- No spaces are permitted in the name field
- Use the name exactly as it appears on official school records

Format: FirstName_SecondName

Examples:

Full Name on Record	Correct Format for File Naming
Sandun Sapumal Disanayaka	Sandun_Sapumal
Nimal Perera	Nimal_Perera
Ayesha Mohamed Ali	Ayesha_Mohamed
Kavindi Jayasinghe	Kavindi_Jayasinghe

Note: Only the first name and second name are used. Surname names and additional family names are excluded from the file naming convention.

b. Exception for Name Duplication:

In cases where two or more students share identical first names and second name (resulting in duplicate file names with the same admission number pattern), second name or additional family names may be used on an exceptional basis to ensure unique identification.

Example of Exception:

Student	Standard Format	Issue	Exceptional Format
Sandun Sapumal Disanayaka (PAN01234)	Sandun_Sapumal	No duplication	Sandun_Sapumal
Sandun Sapumal Fernando (PAN01567)	Sandun_Sapumal	Duplicate name	Sandun_Fernando

In such cases, the Admission Officer must:

- Document the exception in the Master Sheet with a note explaining the duplication
- Apply the extended naming format consistently for all documents related to that student
- Obtain approval from the Branch Principal for the naming exception

9.3 Date Format

Mandatory Requirements:

- Use the date when the document was scanned (not the document's original date)
- Format: DDMMYYYY (Day-Month-Year, 8 digits)
- No spaces, slashes (/), hyphens (-), or any other separators are permitted
- This format ensures compatibility with Microsoft Windows file systems

Format: DDMMYYYY

Examples:

Calendar Date	Correct Format
02/12/2025	02122025
15/03/2024	15032024
01/01/2026	01012026
28/11/2025	28112025

9.4 Complete File Naming Convention

Standard Format:

[AdmissionNumber]_[FirstName_SecondName]_[DocumentCode]_[ScanDate]

Component Breakdown:

- a) **Admission Number:** School-assigned unique identifier (e.g., PAN01234)
- b) **Student Name:** FirstName_SecondName format
- c) **Document Code:** Three-letter code from Section 9.1
- d) **Scan Date:** Eight-digit date format (DDMMYYYY)

Separator: Use underscore () between all components

Complete Examples:

Components	Complete File Name
Admission: PAN01234 Name: Sandun Sapumal Disanayaka Document: Birth Certificate Scan Date: 02/12/2025	PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal_BCR_02122025.pdf
Admission: PAN05678 Name: Nimal Perera Document: Leaving Certificate Scan Date: 15/03/2024	PAN05678_Nimal_Perera_LCR_15032024.pdf
Admission: PAN09876 Name: Ayesha Mohamed Document: Academic Certificate Scan Date: 20/01/2025	PAN09876_Ayesha_Mohamed_ACT_20012025.pdf
Admission: PAN04321 Name: Kavindi Jayasinghe Document: Achievement Certificate Scan Date: 10/06/2025	PAN04321_Kavindi_Jayasinghe_ACH_10062025.pdf

9.5 Multiple Documents of Same Type

When a student has multiple documents of the same type (e.g., multiple result sheets), add a sequential suffix:

Format:

[AdmissionNumber]_[FirstName_SecondName]_[DocumentCode]_[ScanDate]_[SequenceNumber]

Examples:

- a) PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal_ACT_02122025_01.pdf
- b) PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal_ACT_02122025_02.pdf
- c) PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal_ACT_02122025_03.pdf

9.6 File Format Requirements

- a) **File Type:** PDF format only
- b) **File Extension:** .pdf (lowercase)
- c) **Resolution:** Minimum 300 DPI for all scans
- d) **Color:** Color scans required for all documents
- e) **File Size:** Optimize for clarity while keeping under 10MB per file

9.7 Quality Control Checklist

Before finalizing any scanned document, verify:

- a) File name follows exact convention with all underscores in correct positions
- b) Admission number is accurate and matches Master Sheet
- c) Student name matches official school records exactly
- d) Document code is correct and in uppercase
- e) Scan date is the actual date of scanning
- f) File is saved as PDF format
- g) Document is legible at 100% zoom
- h) All pages of multi-page documents are included
- i) No personal information is visible in the file name beyond student name

9.8 Cloud Storage Folder Structure

All scanned student documents shall be organized in a hierarchical folder structure within the school's cloud storage system to ensure systematic organization, easy retrieval, and efficient management.

9.8.1 Primary Folder Structure

Level 1: Root Directory

Leeds_International_School_Student_Records/

Level 2: Branch Folders

Leeds_International_School_Student_Records/

└─ Branch_Panadura/

└─ Branch_Colombo/

└─ Branch_Galle/

└─ Branch_[Location]/

Level 3: Academic Year Folders

Branch_Panadura/

└─ Admitted_2020/

└─ Admitted_2021/

- |— Admitted_2022/
- |— Admitted_2023/
- |— Admitted_2024/
- |— Admitted_2025/

Level 4: Individual Student Folders

Each student folder must follow this naming convention:

[AdmissionNumber]_[FirstName_SecondName]

Example structure:

Admitted_2024/

- |— PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal/
- |— PAN01235_Nimal_Perera/
- |— PAN01236_Ayesha_Mohamed/
- |— PAN01237_Kavindi_Jayasinghe/

9.8.2 Student Folder Sub-Structure

Within each individual student folder, documents must be organized into the following sub-folders:

PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal/

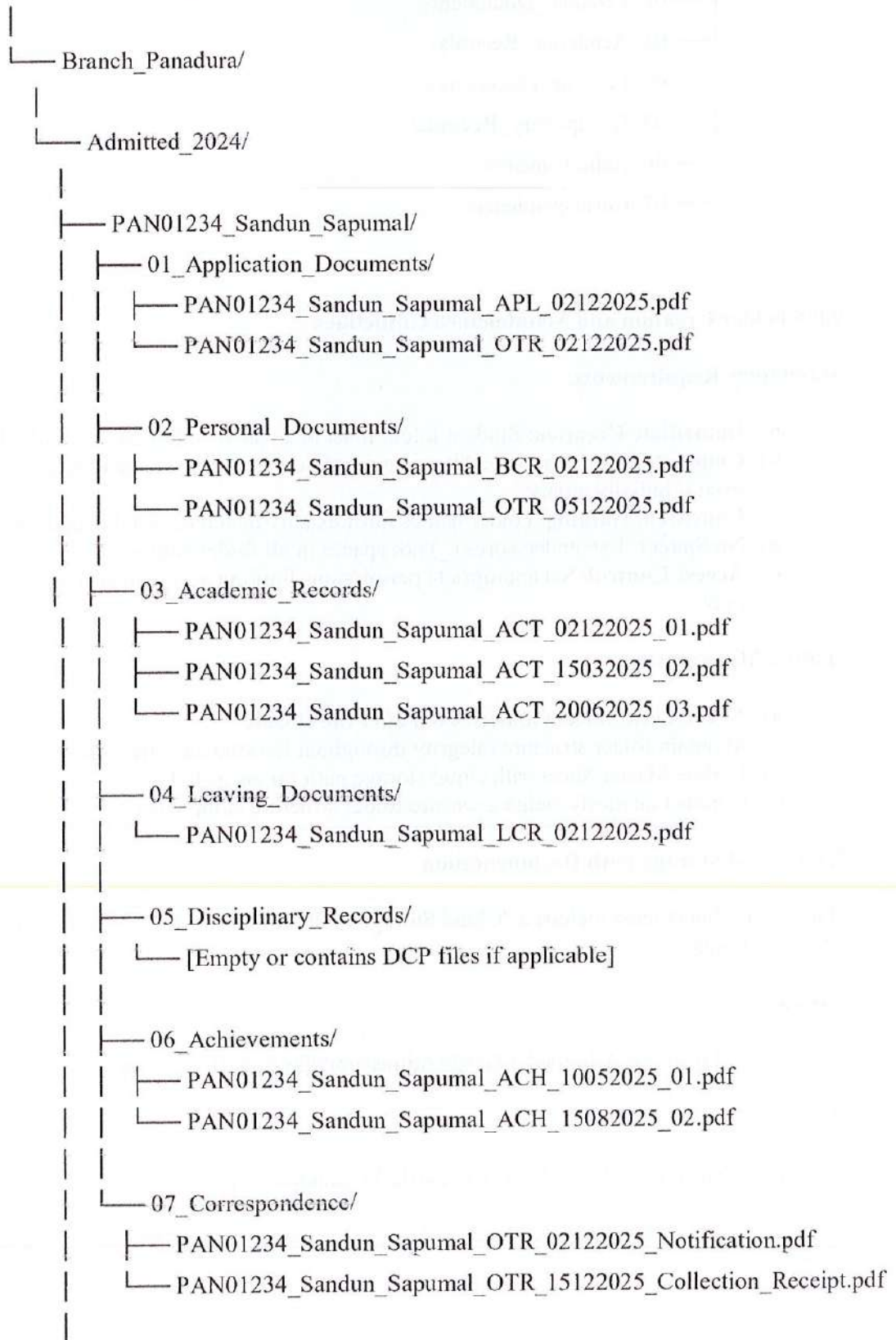
- |— 01_Application_Documents/
- |— 02_Personal_Documents/
- |— 03_Academic_Records/
- |— 04_Leaving_Documents/
- |— 05_Disciplinary_Records/
- |— 06_Achievements/
- |— 07_Correspondence/

9.8.3 Sub-Folder Contents and File Placement

Sub-Folder	Document Types	File Codes	Example Files
01_Application_Documents	Application forms, admission letters,	APL, OTR	PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal_APL_02122025.pdf
02_Personal_Documents	Birth certificates, medical records	BCR, OTR	PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal_BCR_02122025.pdf
03_Academic_Records	Result sheets, report cards, examination certificates, transcripts	ACT	PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal_ACT_02122025_01.pdf PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal_ACT_15032025_02.pdf
04_Leaving_Documents	Leaving certificates, transfer certificates, clearance forms	LCR, OTR	PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal_LCR_02122025.pdf
05_Disciplinary_Records	Disciplinary letters, incident reports, behavior records	DCP	PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal_DCP_02122025.pdf
06_Achievements	Appreciation letters, award certificates, achievement records, sports/cultural certificates	ACH	PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal_ACH_02122025.pdf
07_Correspondence	Parent communication, email records, notification letters, collection receipts	OTR	PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal_OTR_02122025.pdf

9.8.4 Complete Folder Structure Example

Leeds_International_School_Student_Records/



```

└─ PAN01235_Nimal_Perera/
  └─ 01_Application_Documents/
  └─ 02_Personal_Documents/
  └─ 03_Academic_Records/
  └─ 04_Leaving_Documents/
  └─ 05_Disciplinary_Records/
  └─ 06_Achievements/
  └─ 07_Correspondence/

```

9.8.5 Folder Creation and Maintenance Guidelines

Mandatory Requirements:

- Immediate Creation:** Student folder must be created within 24 hours of admission
- Complete Sub-Structure:** All seven sub-folders must be created for every student, even if initially empty
- Consistent Naming:** Folder names must exactly match the established conventions
- No Spaces:** Use underscores () not spaces in all folder names
- Access Control:** Set appropriate permissions limiting access to authorized personnel only

Folder Management:

- Never delete student folders, even after file closure
- Maintain folder structure integrity throughout the student's lifecycle
- Update Master Sheet with cloud storage path for each student
- Conduct quarterly audits to ensure folder structure compliance

9.8.6 Cloud Storage Path Documentation

The Master Sheet must include a "Cloud Storage Path" column with the complete path to each student's folder:

Format:

/Branch_[Location]/Admitted_[Year]/[AdmissionNumber]_[FirstName_SecindName]/

Example:

/Branch_Panadura/Admitted_2024/PAN01234_Sandun_Sapumal/

This enables quick navigation and retrieval of student documents by any authorized staff member.

9.8.7 Backup and Security Requirements

- a) **Automated Backup:** Cloud storage must have automated daily backup enabled
- b) **Password Protection:** All folders must be password protected
- c) **Access Logs:** Maintain audit logs of all folder access and modifications
- d) **Disaster Recovery:** Test recovery procedures quarterly

10. Approval & Revision History

Approval	Name and Designation	Signature
Prepared By	Mr. Binishka Nayananda General Manager - Operations	
Reviewed By	Mr. Tilina Diyagama Director	
Approved By	Mrs. Malithi Jayatissa Deputy Chairperson	

